

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 604

By Massey

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Thomas Hayes "Tommy" Schumpert of Knox County.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly were greatly saddened to learn of the passing of Thomas Hayes "Tommy" Schumpert; and

WHEREAS, Tommy Schumpert's life was one of service to his Lord and Savior Jesus Christ, his family, and Knox County, particularly its youth; and

WHEREAS, born on December 5, 1938, in Dayton, Mr. Schumpert was the son of T.O. Schumpert and Lucy Schumpert; shortly after his birth, his family moved to Knoxville, and he spent more than eighty years of his life living in Fountain City; and

WHEREAS, Tommy Schumpert graduated from Knoxville Central High School in 1956; after lettering in football and earning the title of County Most Valuable Player in the 1955 Knoxville City-County All-Star Game, he attended Tennessee Technological University on a football scholarship before transferring to the University of Tennessee; and

WHEREAS, he graduated from the University of Tennessee in 1960 and began teaching at Knoxville Central High School that same year; he was the head baseball coach from 1968-1973 and led the Bobcats to the 1973 State Championship; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Schumpert became the head football coach at Central in 1973 and led the Bobcats to the State quarterfinals in two of his four years as head coach; he was named *The Knoxville Journal* East Tennessee Football Coach of the Year in 1973; and

WHEREAS, for his service and success at Knoxville Central High School, Tommy Schumpert was included on the Central High School Wall of Fame and was inducted as a member of the high school's Sports Hall of Fame and the Greater Knoxville Sports Hall of Fame; and

WHEREAS, Knoxville Central High School's hitting facility is named after Tommy Schumpert and his longtime friend Bud Bales, and in honor of Mr. Schumpert's service to the city and its youth, the county created Tommy Schumpert Park in Fountain City in 2005; and

WHEREAS, despite leaving Knoxville Central in 1977, he remained in education, serving as the Knox County School Business Manager and then Knox County School Assistant Superintendent before being elected as Knox County Trustee in 1990 and then Knox County Executive, a position now called mayor, in 1994; and

WHEREAS, Tommy Schumpert served two terms as the county mayor from 1994-2002; he was the last Democrat to hold the position, and his tenure was marked by his ability to reach across the aisle for Knoxville's betterment. In his capacity as mayor, he oversaw the creation of eight new parks, pay increases for county employees, and infrastructure improvements to the county's roads; and

WHEREAS, after his time as county mayor, he spent sixteen years as the program director of Edscholar (Edsouth), a nonprofit corporation organized to acquire postsecondary education loans under Title IV of the federal Higher Education Act of 1965; during his decade-plus at Edsouth, the organization provided over \$16 million in scholarships to over 870 students; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Schumpert was a dedicated Christian and servant of the Lord; he was a member of Fountain City United Methodist Church for more than eighty years, teaching Sunday School for over twenty years and taking on countless leadership roles in his decades at the church; and

WHEREAS, above all, he was wholly devoted to his family, making time for his children and grandchildren and frequently traveling for visits and to watch his grandchildren's sporting events; and

WHEREAS, Tommy Schumpert will be sadly mourned yet fondly remembered by his high school sweetheart and wife of sixty-eight years, Charlotte Truan Schumpert; children, Scott (Sally) Schumpert and Laura Schumpert (Mick) Raney; grandsons, Thomas Grant (McKenzie) Schumpert, Andy Schumpert and fiancée Kate Linn, and Ryan Schumpert; great-grandchildren, Kate Schumpert and Adrian Thomas Schumpert; brother, R.B. (Susan) Schumpert; brother-in-law, Bill (Mila) Truan; and nieces and nephews, David (Nancy) Graves, Debbie (Mitch) Parks, Kim Schumpert, and Amy Schumpert; and

WHEREAS, in addition to his parents, Mr. Schumpert was preceded in death by his sister, Billie Ruth Graves, and her husband, Fred Graves, Jr.; and

WHEREAS, Tommy Schumpert will be remembered for his dignified leadership, his lifelong service to Knox County, his devotion to faith and family, and his enduring connection to his community; his legacy lives on in the thousands of lives he touched; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to remember the bountiful life of this exceptional public servant and human being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Thomas Hayes "Tommy" Schumpert, reflecting fondly upon his impeccable character and his stalwart commitment to living the examined life with courage and conviction.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we express our sympathy and offer our condolences to the family of Mr. Schumpert.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.